Semester Legal Drafting Pack

Prepared October 6, 2026. U.S.-oriented planning aids, not legal advice, executed agreements, filings, or verified company status. All company facts must be checked. Use the HTML artifact for local interactive tracking and agreement review drafts.

Founder vesting checklist

DRAFT CHECKLIST — counsel review required
[ ] Confirm corporation/share instrument; do not reuse for LLC interests without revision.
[ ] Confirm founder, share class, number, purchase price and fully diluted ownership assumptions.
[ ] Document approval and actual transfer date separately from vesting start date.
[ ] Choose vesting duration, cliff, installment frequency and any prior-service credit.
[ ] Define continued service and departure consequences.
[ ] Define company repurchase right, price, exercise period and procedure.
[ ] Choose no acceleration, single-trigger, or double-trigger provisions with defined terms.
[ ] Execute stock purchase and IP assignment; retain payment and issuance evidence.
[ ] Assess 83(b) with tax adviser immediately after transfer; retain filing evidence and required copies.
[ ] Reconcile ledger, cap table and vesting register; diarize repurchase deadlines.
Illustration only: four years, one-year cliff, 25% at cliff, remaining 75% in 36 monthly installments. Not a legal requirement.

IP assignment drafting brief

DRAFTING BRIEF — NOT AN EXECUTABLE AGREEMENT
Parties: [assignor], [exact company legal name], [jurisdiction].

1. Existing-IP schedule: repositories, commits, code, designs, datasets, documents, marks and domains; creator and ownership evidence for each.
2. Existing transfer: counsel drafts present assignment of specifically identified rights owned by assignor; not merely a promise to assign later.
3. Ongoing services: separate employee/contractor confidentiality and inventions agreement; define covered services and legally permitted scope.
4. Prior/background IP: list exclusions; if embedded, obtain a sufficient license covering customer operation, distribution and sublicensing as needed.
5. Third-party work: list licenses, open-source obligations and university/employer/sponsor interests. Do not purport to assign rights not owned.
6. Confidentiality; permitted disclosures; further assurances; moral rights treatment only as legally permitted; return of access/assets.

7. Contractor deliverables and any payment-dependent ownership trigger must be explicit; work-made-for-hire language alone is not a universal substitute for assignment.
8. Counsel checks employee invention exclusions and local law. Retain executed records and map assets to agreements.

DPA processing annex

DRAFT ANNEX — ALL ENTRIES REQUIRE FACTUAL VALIDATION
Controller/customer: [name]. Processor: [Semester legal entity].
Subject matter / purposes: [specific authorized services]. Duration: [term and post-term handling].
Data subjects: [students, faculty, staff, guardians as applicable].
Data types: [actual categories; flag child/sensitive/education records].
Operations: [collection, hosting, retrieval, support, export etc.].
Instructions and contacts: [documented mechanism].
Regions/transfers: [locations, recipients, transfer mechanism and assessment where needed].
Subprocessors: [name, service, location, data, notice/objection process].
Retention: [per-category retention; active deletion; backup rotation; legal holds].
Technical/organizational measures: [verified controls and evidence].
Rights/incident assistance: [workflow, contacts and actual capacity].
Private student workspace: [separate authority/access boundary].
AI: [providers, permitted inputs, provider retention, training restrictions, approvals].

Compliance calendar template

ID | jurisdiction | obligation | applicability decision | trigger | verified due date | owner | reviewer | evidence | next recurrence
Do not assume a uniform state annual report, tax, or qualification deadline.

IP inventory template

Asset ID | description | creator | creation date | repository/location | employer/university obligations | ownership basis | signed assignment/license | exclusions | reviewer

Vesting register template

Founder | shares | purchase price | transfer date | vesting start | duration | cliff | installments | acceleration | departure date | repurchase deadline | 83(b) status | evidence

Financing drafting brief

Choose SAFE, note or priced financing with counsel. Record instrument terms, approvals, investor rights, exemption, first-sale date, applicable federal/state filings, funds receipts and cap-table effects. Never substitute this brief for definitive documents.

NVCA drafting brief

Use current counsel-selected NVCA forms as applicable: charter, stock purchase agreement, investors rights agreement, voting agreement, ROFR/co-sale agreement. Add schedules, approvals, side letters, conversion calculations and closing evidence.

Filing checklist

Identify applicable offering exemption; confirm whether Form D is required; verify first irrevocable contractual investment commitment; assess 15-day deadline and applicable holiday/weekend adjustment; assess each state notice/fee separately; retain submission evidence. This app calculates candidate dates only.

Activation checklist

Verify product acceptance, actual privacy/security controls, signed terms, authorized data sources and user roles. Official records/actions require separate institution approval, bounded execution, reconciliation and recovery evidence.

Diligence index

Corporate records; stock ledger/cap table; founder and staff IP; financing instruments; financial statements; taxes; material contracts; privacy/security evidence; litigation; vendor dependencies; capability status; unresolved risks.

Closing checklist

Counsel confirms charter effectiveness, approvals, definitive signatures, conversion math, payment, share issuance, ledger and closing binder. Do not mark closed from a term sheet alone.

Post-close checklist

Assess new offering filings, state notices, governance changes, side-letter obligations, equity plan, investor reporting and recurring corporate compliance. Retain receipts and approvals.

Financing register

Investor | instrument | investment | first-sale determination | execution date | proceeds received | cap/discount/interest | side rights | approvals | conversion | filings | evidence

Corporate approvals

Counsel-prepared approval checklist: action, legal authority, directors/stockholders entitled to act, conflicts, approval threshold, effective date, attached documents, signature evidence. Not a resolution template.

Government filing

Use current official jurisdiction forms after counsel review. Record filing identity, authority, submission date, effective date and receipt.

Government filings / records

Assess EIN, bank authority, taxes and operating/foreign registrations based on actual entity and activities; use official forms and retain confirmations.

Decision record

Decision | options | selected approach | assumptions | jurisdiction | accountable owner | legal/tax reviewer | date | dependencies | evidence

Sources

- IRS Form 15620 — 83(b) instructions
- SEC — Form D filing
- Cooley — founder vesting
- Cooley — contractor assignment
- GDPR Article 28 text
- California Civil Code 1798.100
- NVCA model documents
- YC SAFE documents